

**Practice Set****Tense – SSC CGL Previous Year Questions**

**Complete English Practice:** [https://t.me/Sampuran\\_English](https://t.me/Sampuran_English)

**Click & Ask Your Doubts:** <https://t.me/sampuranenglish>

*Directions (Q.1–19): The following sentences have been divided into parts (a), (b), (c) and (d). One part contains a grammatical error related to Tense. Find out which part has the error. If a sentence is free from error, the answer is (d)/No error.*

**Qus.1.** I am sure that (a)/ the postman would be coming (b)/ shortly to deliver the letter. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.2.** If things were not going to be normal (a)/ after the pandemic, mankind will (b)/ have to accept the New Normal. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.3.** They had been dancing (a)/ for an hour when (b)/ our dance teacher had arrived. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.4.** When Mrs. Sinha came to see Varanasi in 2019, (a)/ Nupur has already been (b)/ teaching there for five years. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.5.** She was writing (a)/ a letter to her grandmother (b)/ when the power gone out. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.6.** I shall wait for you (a)/ till you will (b)/ finish your lunch. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.7.** It is high time (a)/ you start preparing (b)/ for the exam. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.8.** This is the first time (a)/ I ate such (b)/ a tasty cake.(c)/No error (d)

**Qus.9.** If it will rain, (a)/ we will have (b)/ a tough time. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.10.** Everybody knows that (a)/ he has been working (b)/ here since five years. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.11.** In 2023, she will has been (a)/ working in the company (b)/ for three years. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.12.** We have been arranged the stay (a)/ for the guests at (b)/ a hillside resort. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.13.** Radha will have learnt cooking (a)/ by the time (b)/ she will have married. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.14.** I had gone (a)/ to Siliguri before (b)/ I gone to Raiganj. (c)/No error

**Qus.15.** It is time (a)/ you have gone (b)/ home. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.16.** Binay said that (a)/ he is coming from (b)/ his village, Jaygarh. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.17.** Jaya said that (a)/ she will become topper (b)/ in her class. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.18.** Neetu have been (a)/ waiting for me (b)/ since 10 o'clock in the morning. (c)/ No error (d)

**Qus.19.** Anant was telling a story (a)/ about his most recent exploits (b)/ when a tree branch break the living room window. (c)/ No error (d)

## ANSWERS & EXPLANATIONS

**Ans.1. (b)**

*[SSC CGL 24/07/2023, 1st Shift]*

**Exp.** Replace “would be” with “will be”. ‘I am sure’ is in the Present Tense and expresses present certainty about a future event, so the clause that follows should use ‘will’ (future), not ‘would’, which belongs to past or hypothetical contexts.

**Rule:** *A present-tense main clause expressing certainty about the future takes ‘will’, not ‘would’.*

**Ex-** I am sure that he will win the match. (Correct)

**Ans.2. (b)**

[SSC CGL 21/07/2023, 3rd Shift]

**Exp.** Replace “will” with “would”. The if-clause uses the past form ‘were’, which signals a Second Conditional structure; therefore the main clause must use ‘would’, not ‘will’.

**Rule:** *Second Conditional: If + Simple Past, ... would + V1.*

**Ex-** If it rained, we would stay indoors. (Correct)

**Ans.3. (c)**

[SSC MTS 05/09/2023, 2nd Shift]

**Exp.** Replace “had arrived” with “arrived”. ‘When + Simple Past Tense’ is used to show the exact point of time at which a longer past action (had been dancing) was interrupted or ended.

**Rule:** *Past Perfect Continuous (longer action) + when + Simple Past (shorter/interrupting action).*

**Ex-** She had been reading for two hours when the light went off. (Correct)

**Ans.4. (b)**

[SSC CGL 26/07/2023, 1st Shift]

**Exp.** Replace “has already” with “had already”. An action that started before a certain point in the past and continued up to that point takes the Past Perfect Continuous Tense, not the Present Perfect Continuous, because the reference point (‘came...in 2019’) is itself in the past.

**Rule:** *Past Perfect Continuous = had been + V-ing, for an action continuing up to a specific point in the past.*

**Ex-** When I met him, he had been living in Delhi for ten years. (Correct)

**Ans.5. (d)**

[SSC MTS 08/09/2023, 2nd Shift]

**Exp.** No error. As per the rule below, ‘when’ is followed by the Simple Past Tense (V2), not a past participle, to show the interrupting action.

**Rule:** *Sub. + was/were + V-ing + when + Sub. + V2.*

**Ex-** He was cooking when the guests arrived. (Correct)

**Ans.6. (b)**

[SSC Stenographer 2013]

**Exp.** Remove 'will' from this part. Time-clause conjunctions such as 'till/until, before, when, as soon as' already carry the sense of futurity, so 'will/shall' is not repeated inside that clause even though the meaning is future.

**Rule:** *In a time clause with till/until/before/when/as soon as, use the Simple Present (not will/shall) for future meaning.*

**Ex-** I will call you when he arrives. (not 'will arrive')

**Ans.7. (b)**

**Exp.** Use "started" in place of "start". The expression "It is high time" means "the action is already overdue and should have started by now." After "It is high time", we use the Simple Past (Past Indefinite), even though we are talking about the present or future.

**Rule:** *It is high time + Subject + V<sup>2</sup> (Past Indefinite)*

**Ex-** It is high time she went home. It is high time we left.

**Ans.8. (b)**

[SSC MTS 06/09/2023, 1st Shift]

**Exp.** Replace "I ate such" with "I have eaten such". When we say something is happening for the first (or only) time up to the present moment, we use the Present Perfect Tense, not the Simple Past.

**Rule:** *"This is the first/second/only time" + Present Perfect (has/have + V3).*

**Ex-** This is the first time I have visited Goa. (Correct)

**Ans.9. (a)**

[SSC CGL 21/07/2023, 4th Shift]

**Exp.** Replace "if it will rain" with "if it rains". In a First Conditional sentence, the 'if-clause' is written in the Simple Present Tense, while the main clause uses 'will + base verb'.

**Rule:** *First Conditional: If + Simple Present, ... will + V1.*

**Ex-** If it rains, we will stay indoors. (Correct)

**Ans.10. (c)**

**Exp.** Use “for” in place of “since”. The sentence talks about a period of time. We use the preposition “for” to talk about a period of time (5 years, 3 hours, 6 months, etc.) and the preposition “since” to talk about a point of time (2018, independence, etc.)

**Ans.11. (a)**

*[SSC CGL 26/07/2023, 4th Shift]*

**Exp.** Replace “will has been” with “will have been”. The Future Perfect Continuous Tense always uses ‘have’ after ‘will’, regardless of the subject; ‘has’ is never used after a modal like ‘will’.

**Rule:** *Future Perfect Continuous = Sub. + will have been + V-ing.*

**Ex-** By next year, he will have been teaching for a decade. (Correct)

**Ans.12. (a)**

*[SSC CPO 04/10/2023, 3rd Shift]*

**Exp.** Replace “have been” with “have”. The sentence is in the Present Perfect Tense and in active voice, and the correct structure is: ‘Plural Subject + have + V3’.

**Rule:** *Present Perfect → Sub. + has/have + V3 (past participle).*

**Ex-** They have completed the project. (Correct)

**Ans.13. (c)**

*[SSC MTS 11/09/2023, 2nd Shift]*

**Exp.** Replace “she will have married” with “she marries”. After the phrase ‘by the time’, the clause that fixes the future reference point is written in the Simple Present Tense, even though its meaning is future; the main clause alone carries the future/future-perfect form.

**Rule:** *“By the time” + Simple Present (reference clause); main clause takes Future/Future Perfect.*

**Ex-** I will have finished the report by the time you arrive. (Correct)

**Ans.14. (c)**

[SSC CGL 20/07/2023, 4th Shift]

**Exp.** Replace “gone” with “went”. When two actions happened in the past and one occurred before the other, the earlier action is put in the Past Perfect Tense (had + V3) and the later action is put in the Simple Past Tense (V2). Here “had gone” is already Past Perfect, so “gone” must become “went”.

**Rule:** *Earlier past action → had + V3; later past action → V2 (Simple Past).*

**Ex-** I had finished dinner before he arrived. (Correct)

**Ans.15. (b)**

**Exp.** Use “went” in place of “have gone”. After “It is time”, we use the Simple Past (Past Indefinite), not the Present Perfect.

**Rule:** *It is time + Subject + V<sup>2</sup> (Past Indefinite)*

**Ex-** It is time we started our project.

*Note: The phrase “It is time” expresses that the action should happen now or should already have happened. English uses the past tense after this expression to show urgency or that the action is overdue.*

**Ans.16. (b)**

[SSC CGL 21/07/2023, 2nd Shift]

**Exp.** Replace “he is coming” with “he was coming”. In indirect (reported) speech, when the reporting verb (‘said’) is in the past tense, the tense of the reported clause shifts one step back — Present Continuous changes to Past Continuous.

**Rule:** *Reporting verb in past → Present Continuous (is/am/are + V-ing) becomes Past Continuous (was/were + V-ing).*

**Ex-** He said that he was going to Delhi. (Correct)

**Ans.17. (b)**

[SSC MTS 05/09/2023, 3rd Shift]

**Exp.** Replace “will become” with “would become”. As the reporting verb ‘said’ is in the past tense, the modal ‘will’ in the reported clause must shift back to ‘would’.

**Rule:** *Reporting verb in past → will/shall shifts to would/should.*

**Ex-** She said that she would come tomorrow. (Correct)

**Ans.18. (a)**

[SSC CGL 14/07/2023, 1st Shift]

**Exp.** Replace “have” with “has”. “Neetu” is a singular subject, so it takes the singular auxiliary “has”. The word “since 10 o’clock” shows that the action started in the past and is still continuing now, which is the Present Perfect Continuous Tense.

**Rule:** *Present Perfect Continuous → Singular Sub. + has been + V-ing; Plural Sub. + have been + V-ing.*

**Ex-** She has been working here since 2019. (Correct)

**Ans.19. (c)**

[SSC CPO 04/10/2023, 2nd Shift]

**Exp.** Replace “break” with “broke”. When an ongoing action in the past (was telling) is suddenly interrupted by another action, the interrupting action is expressed in the Simple Past Tense.

**Rule:** *Past Continuous (ongoing action) + when + Simple Past (interrupting action).*

**Ex-** I was sleeping when the phone rang. (Correct)

---

**Complete English Practice:** [https://t.me/Sampuran\\_English](https://t.me/Sampuran_English)

**Click & Ask Your Doubts:** <https://t.me/sampuranenglish>